RAJASTHANI COLLECTION

NO. 10



RAJASTHAN ORIGIN

Besan Gatta Pulao

Spiced Rice with Gram Flour Dumplings

A One-Pot Rajasthani Original

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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Besan Gatta Pulao

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Besan Gatta Pulao

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DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Two Rajasthani Traditions, Combined

Besan gatta pulao represents a creative synthesis within Rajasthani cooking — taking the gatte technique found in gatte ki sabzi and govind gatta curry elsewhere in this collection and folding it directly into a spiced pulao, rather than serving the dumplings in a separate gravy alongside rice or roti. The result is a genuinely one-pot meal, combining the protein and texture of gram flour dumplings with fragrant, whole-spice-infused rice in a single dish.

This kind of combination reflects a practical evolution of Rajasthani cooking — where gatte ki sabzi solved the problem of a curry without fresh vegetables, besan gatta pulao solves a related but distinct problem: how to create a complete, satisfying one-pot meal using the same reliable, shelf-stable gram flour that defines so much of the region's resourceful cooking style.

While less historically documented than dishes like dal baati churma, besan gatta pulao has become a genuinely popular modern addition to Rajasthani home cooking and restaurant menus, valued for offering the familiar, beloved gatte texture in a format that requires less separate preparation than a traditional gatte curry served alongside rice.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Two Rajasthani Traditions, Combined, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

A creative combination of Rajasthan's gatte dumpling tradition with pulao, folding both techniques into a single one-pot dish. Reflects the practical, resourceful spirit found throughout Rajasthani cooking, extending the gram flour dumpling concept into a new format. Less historically documented than older Rajasthani classics, representing a more modern evolution of traditional techniques. Increasingly popular in Rajasthani homes and restaurants as a convenient, complete one-pot meal.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

25m	30m	6	Med
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Mixing bowl
- Large pot, for boiling the gatte
- Heavy-bottomed pot with a tight lid, for the pulao
- Fine mesh strainer

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Besan gatta pulao keeps refrigerated for up to 3 days. Reheat gently with a splash of water, covered, to restore moisture without drying out the rice. It freezes reasonably well for up to a month.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the gatte

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Besan (gram flour)	1 cup	120 g	1 katori
Ajwain (carom seeds)	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Turmeric powder	¼ tsp	1 g	¼ chammach
Yogurt	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Oil	1 tbsp	15 ml	1 chammach
Salt	¼ tsp	1.5 g	to taste
Water, as needed	2–3 tbsp	30–45 ml	2–3 chammach

For the pulao

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Basmati rice	1½ cups	300 g	1½ katori
Ghee or oil	3 tbsp	45 g	3 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Cinnamon stick	1 inch	1 inch	1 inch
Cloves	3	3	3
Green cardamom	3	3	3
Bay leaf	1	1	1

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

For the pulao (cont.)

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Onion, sliced	1 medium	100 g	1 medium
Ginger-garlic paste	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Green chili, slit	2	2	2
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Water	2¾ cups	660 ml	2¾ katori
Salt	1½ tsp	9 g	to taste
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

This dish uses the same besan gatte technique found elsewhere in this collection, alongside standard pulao ingredients — both widely accessible. Basmati rice is strongly preferred for its fragrance and texture, holding up well against the more robustly flavored gatte pieces.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Gatte

01 MAKE AND SHAPE THE DOUGH

Combine besan, ajwain, turmeric, yogurt, oil, and salt. Gradually add water, kneading to a firm dough, then shape into thin ropes.

02 BOIL AND SLICE

Boil the ropes in gently simmering water for 12–15 minutes, until firm. Cool slightly, then slice into small rounds, smaller than you might for gatte ki sabzi, since these will be mixed through rice.



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Making the Gatte, continued

Chef tip. cutting the gatte into smaller pieces than usual helps them distribute more evenly throughout the rice.

COOKING CHECKPOINT

The gatte should be firm and cooked through before slicing, with no soft, doughy center remaining.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Building the Pulao

03 RINSE AND SOAK THE RICE

Rinse the basmati rice until the water runs mostly clear, then soak for 20 minutes. Drain thoroughly.

04 BLOOM THE WHOLE SPICES

Heat ghee in a heavy-bottomed pot and add cumin seeds, cinnamon, cloves, cardamom, and bay leaf, letting them sizzle until fragrant.

05 SAUTÉ THE ONION

Add the sliced onion, cooking until golden, about 6–7 minutes. Stir in the ginger-garlic paste and green chilies, cooking until fragrant.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Building the Pulao, continued



06 ADD RICE AND GATTE

Add the drained rice and turmeric, stirring gently to coat, then fold in the sliced gatte pieces.

07 ADD WATER AND COOK

Add the water and salt, bring to a boil, then reduce heat to the lowest setting, cover tightly, and cook undisturbed for 15–18 minutes.

08 REST AND FLUFF

Turn off the heat and let the pot rest, covered, for 10 minutes before fluffing gently with a fork.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Building the Pulao, continued

Texture indicator. the rice should be fully cooked with distinct, separate grains, the gatte pieces distributed evenly throughout without breaking apart.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Stirring the pulao vigorously once the gatte are added can break them apart. Fold gently, and avoid excessive stirring once the rice is cooking.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served as a complete one-pot meal, needing little more than a side of yogurt or pickle.
- A convenient alternative to serving gatte curry and rice separately.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Restaurant Presentation

- Served in a mound on a plate, garnished with fresh coriander, alongside a small bowl of raita.

Family Style

- A satisfying, complete family meal that requires only one pot to prepare.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Texture Right

- Cutting the gatte into small pieces helps them integrate throughout the rice rather than clumping in one area.
- Gentle folding rather than vigorous stirring once everything is combined preserves both the rice grains and the gatte pieces.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- The gatte can be boiled and sliced a day ahead, refrigerated, ready to fold into fresh pulao.
- This dish reheats reasonably well, making it a practical make-ahead option for busy weeks.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some cooks lightly fry the sliced gatte in ghee before adding them to the pulao, giving a slightly crisp edge that holds up well within the rice.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

340 kcal	10 g	52 g	10 g	4 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with ghee and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Classic Besan Gatta Pulao	the version featured here, combining both traditions in one pot.
Vegetable Besan Gatta Pulao	some households add peas or carrots for extra color and nutrition.
Fried Gatta Pulao	gatte pan-fried before being added to the rice, for extra texture.

Can I use leftover gatte from another dish?

Yes — leftover boiled gatte from gatte ki sabzi works well here, simply sliced smaller and folded into the pulao.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Why did my rice turn mushy?

Likely too much water, or stirring too vigorously during cooking. Follow the water measurements closely and avoid stirring once the rice is simmering.

Is this dish very spicy?

It's moderately spiced with warmth from whole spices and green chili — adjust chili quantity to your preference.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



GLOSSARY

Gatte	gram flour dumplings, folded into this dish's rice.
Pulao	a rice dish cooked with whole spices, the base technique for this recipe.
Besan	gram flour, the base for the dumplings in this dish.
Ajwain	carom seeds, used in the gatte dough for aroma.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Besan Gatta Pulao

25m	30m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
6	Med
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

GATTE

Besan	120 g
Ajwain	1.5 g
Turmeric powder	1 g
Yogurt	15 g
Oil	15 ml
Salt	1.5 g
Water	30–45 ml

PULAO

Basmati rice	300 g
Ghee or oil	45 g
Cumin seeds	4 g
Cinnamon stick	1 inch
Cloves	3
Green cardamom	3
Bay leaf	1
Onion	100 g
Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
Green chili	2
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Water	660 ml
Salt	9 g
Fresh coriander	8 g

METHOD

01 **Make and shape the dough.** Combine besan, ajwain, turmeric, yogurt, oil, and salt.

02 **Boil and slice.** Boil the ropes in gently simmering water for 12–15 minutes, until firm.

03 **Rinse and soak the rice.** Rinse the basmati rice until the water runs mostly clear, then soak for 20 minutes.

04 **Bloom the whole spices.** Heat ghee in a heavy-bottomed pot and add cumin seeds, cinnamon, cloves, cardamom, and bay leaf, letting them sizzle until fragrant.

05 **Sauté the onion.** Add the sliced onion, cooking until golden, about 6–7 minutes.

06 **Add rice and gatte.** Add the drained rice and turmeric, stirring gently to coat, then fold in the sliced gatte pieces.

07 **Add water and cook.** Add the water and salt, bring to a boil, then reduce heat to the lowest setting, cover tightly, and cook undisturbed for 15–18 minutes.

08 **Rest and fluff.** Turn off the heat and let the pot rest, covered, for 10 minutes before fluffing gently with a fork.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Besan	120 g	☐ Ajwain	1.5 g
☐ Turmeric powder	see recipe	☐ Yogurt	15 g
☐ Oil	15 ml	☐ Salt	see recipe
☐ Basmati rice	300 g	☐ Ghee or oil	45 g
☐ Cumin seeds	4 g	☐ Cinnamon stick	1 inch
☐ Cloves	3	☐ Green cardamom	3
☐ Bay leaf	1	☐ Onion	100 g
☐ Ginger-garlic paste	15 g	☐ Green chili	2
☐ Fresh coriander	8 g		

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